

CIRQLSPACE — Your Sandbox · Build Plan

"Your CIRQLSPACE is yours — a blank world you paint, build, grow, and throw parties in. The rest of the game lives out in the Town and the endless wilds."

A major new chapter for the CIRQL flagship. **CIRQLSPACE (ring 0)** is reinvented as the player's blank, personal, fully-buildable **Minecraft-like sandbox**. All *game* content moves out to an authored **Town** (ring 1); procedural exploration begins at **ring 2**. The concentric ocean finally *means* something:

ring 0 = you · ring 1 = the community (Town) · ring 2+ = the endless wilds.

Status (2026-07-07): **PLANNING — nothing built yet**. Owner has approved the vision + the phase plan below; build begins only on the owner's "go", phase by phase. This plan mirrors the Linear project "**CIRQLSPACE — Your Sandbox**" (team CHR). Regenerate the PDF whenever this plan or the Linear register changes (owner standing request).

Why this pivot

The old ring-0 "home with stuff on it" (cottage, arcade door, quests, trees, the business landmarks) cluttered the personal space and mixed *your* place with *the game*. Splitting them:

- **CIRQLSPACE = pure self-expression** — customize it, show it off, host parties. A status symbol + a creative outlet.
- **The Town = where the game lives** — quests, stores, the arcade door, NPCs, the how-to.
- **The real-world tie becomes the economy, not scenery**. Retire the in-world business landmarks (off-concept, cluttered). Instead: real rewards + games + quests + campaigns earn **SPARQS**, and SPARQS build your space (décor + land). A cleaner, more monetizable moat.

Locked decisions (owner, 2026-07-07)

- **Full sandbox**: paint the **ground** (terrain tiles) *and* place **objects**.
- **Placement**: free-form + an **optional grid snap**.
- **Live parties**: your CIRQLSPACE is a **shared instance** friends gather in; host toggles **open (anyone online)** ↔ **invite-only**; **cap 8**; **host-only editing** (visitors hang out / chat / emote).
- **Catalog launches BIG** — nature + structures + furniture, lots of items.
- **Growth**: start **cozy**, expand outward in **~6–8 SPARQS-priced tiers** (escalating) + a few **free milestone unlocks** (finish the build tutorial / host first party / N visitors); a hard **estate cap** (save + party-stream perf). **First 2–3 tiers reachable through play alone**; the big estate tiers are the long SPARQS haul.
- **Décor/objects are CIRQLSPACE-only** — cannot be placed on the Town or the wilds (would interfere with gameplay).
- **Onboarding**: spawn on your blank space → a **guide NPC** teaches *building* → the how-to then lives in your **Inventory** (owned stock + SPARQS balance + guide pages). Movement/interact tutorials move to the **Town**.
- **Monetize** décor + land via SPARQS earned through rewards programs, other games, quests, campaigns.

The economy loop (the moat)

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play games · finish quests/campaigns · earn real-world rewards (taps)

└─▶ SPARQS (banked server-side in the **sparqbank** wallet)

└─▶ buy décor + expand land at the Town store

└─▶ build your unique CIRQLSPACE

└─▶ friends visit + party ─▶ (they want one too)

...

Foundations already shipped in "CIRQL — Flagship World": the **sparqbank** wallet (arcade already earns SPARQS), the décor place/persist system, single-visitor visiting, presence/chat/emotes.

Phases (milestones) & issues

A · Restructure — blank CIRQLSPACE + Town (*the foundation*)

- **CHR-266 — Strip CIRQLSPACE to a blank buildable canvas.** Remove ring-0 pre-placed content (cottage, CirqlCade door, trees/ponds/flowers/rocks/paths/lanterns, Sunken Runes, markers, Commons). Keep only a **guide NPC** + a **dock**.
- **CHR-267 — Author the Town hub at ring 1.** Move CirqlCade, quest-givers (Ferra), the Commons, the Sunken Runes, onboarding here. Shops land here later (F).
- **CHR-268 — Shift procedural generation to start at ring 2.** Ring-gen indexing, docks (Town↔ring 2), minimap/sea-chart counting, cross-ring quests/campaigns.
- **CHR-269 — Rework onboarding.** Guide NPC teaches *building*; movement/interact tutorials move to the Town.
- **CHR-270 — Inventory panel.** Owned/placeable stock + **SPARQS balance** + **how-to/guide pages**.
- **CHR-271 — Remove business landmarks + enforce CIRQLSPACE-only placement.** Retire CHR-261; harden the ring-0-only rule.

B · Building v1 (objects)

- **CHR-272 — Big placeable catalog.** Nature (trees/ponds/flowers/bushes/rocks/grass), structures (paths/fences/walls/arches/bridges/gates), furniture (benches/lamps/fountains/statues/banners), themed sets. Data-driven (expand `cirql-decor.ts`); SPARQS-priced.
- **CHR-273 — Placement: free-form + optional grid snap; move/rotate/remove.** A proper build-mode UX.
- **CHR-274 — SPARQS buy→place economy + Inventory stock.** Buy with SPARQS (from the `sparqbank` wallet); owned → placeable stock. Balance the earn→price curve.
- **CHR-275 — Object caps + compact save encoding.** Per-space cap; compact `{id,x,y,rot}` serialization; small enough to stream to party visitors.

C · Terrain paint (*Linear issues pending — free-tier cap; tracked here*)

- **C1 — Ground tilemap model + compact save encoding.** A tile-grid over the buildable area; run-length/packed encoding; default grass; grows with the land.
- **C2 — Paint brush UI.** Pick a tile (grass/sand/stone/water/path) + brush size; a build-mode with **paint** + **place** tabs; mobile-clean.
- **C3 — Water = non-walkable (collision) + render layer.** Water tiles block walking; terrain renders under objects, tinted per tile with soft blended edges.

D · Land growth (cozy → estate) (*Linear issues pending — cap*)

- **D1 — Cozy start + expansion tiers.** ~6–8 tiers widening the buildable land; **SPARQS-priced, escalating**.
- **D2 — Milestone unlocks + estate cap.** Free tiers via *tutorial done* / *first party* / *N visitors*; first 2–3 reachable by play; hard cap for perf.
- **D3 — Expansion UX + new-land-as-blank.** Buy/unlock flow; new land arrives blank grass, ready to paint/build; growth is visible (status symbol).

E · Live parties (*Linear issues pending — cap*)

- **E1 — Space rooms on presence.** A room per CIRQLSPACE keyed by host id (extend `server/cirql-presence.ts`); join/leave.
- **E2 — Stream the host build to visitors.** Send terrain + objects on join so everyone sees the same space live.
- **E3 — Open/invite toggle + cap 8 + host-only edit.** Host sets open→invite-only; visitors move/chat/emote but can't edit.
- **E4 — Live presence in a space + return home.** Remote avatars/movement/chat/emote scoped to the space; a way back to your own.

F · Town stores (NPC shops) (*Linear issues pending — cap*)

- **F1 — Shop buildings → interiors + shopkeeper NPCs.** Walk into a Town shop (reuse the sub-map primitive) → an NPC.
- **F2 — Store inventory model.** Common pool + per-store **exclusives** + super-special SPARQS items (wings, witch hats, staffs).
- **F3 — Store panel + buy flow (replaces menu-buying).** Buying always means visiting a shopkeeper.
- **F4 — Quest-gated / hidden stores.** Some shops open only after a quest/clue.

G · Music & SFX (*Linear issues pending — cap*)

- **G1 — CIRQLSPACE MusicKit.** Adaptive, area-varied, **hybrid** (chiptune melody over ambient pads). Attach to the existing retro-engine `MusicKit` framework.
- **G2 — Action + movement SFX.** place / paint / buy / sail / jump / emote / quest / party. Procedural, no audio files.
- **G3 — Mix/mute controls + integration.**

Sequence & shippability

A is the foundation everything sits on and ships first. Then **B** (objects) → **C** (terrain) → **D** (growth) → **E** (parties) → **F** (stores) → **G** (music). Each phase ships on its own and is verified in-browser. Build begins per phase on the owner's "go".

Open threads (to settle as we reach each phase)

- Terrain **grid resolution** vs save/stream size; **object cap** number.
- **Catalog contents + pricing** (tie to SPARQS earn rates).
- **Starting plot size + estate cap** size; exact **expansion tier prices**.
- **Party** discovery/invite flow + moderation (minor-safe; reuses existing chat moderation).
- Fate of existing **onboarding quests** when moved to the Town.

Notes / constraints

- Client-authoritative save (the `cirql` `game_progress` blob) holds terrain + objects + owned + land tier; multiplayer/party state is in-memory on `/ws/cirql`.
- **Linear free-tier issue cap** was hit while seeding issues — only milestones A & B have granular issues (CHR-266–275); C–G are captured at the milestone level in Linear + fully here. Upgrade Linear to add the rest as issues.